APPENDIX

Material Submitted For The Hearing Record

Prepared Statement of the Honorable Gene Green, A Representative in Congress From the State of Texas

Thank you, Mr. Chairman, for holding this hearing.

I would like to welcome our distinguished panel and thank them for being here today.

Pakistan plays an instrumental role in our foreign policy and counterterrorism efforts in the Middle East, and given the political change that we have witnessed there over the last six months, this hearing is long overdue.

Since 9/11, America has worked closely with President Musharaff and the Pakistani army to conduct counterterrorism operations in the Middle East.

Now, with a new Pakistani parliament in power, it is questionable how influential President Musharaff is these days.

What we do know, however, is that Islamist extremism and militancy, especially in the Federally Administered Tribal Areas, continues to grow.

Al Quaeda also continues to operate in the western part of the country and threaten our progress in Afghanistan.

Nationwide in Pakistan, the human rights situation has worsened and inflation is rising.

Several food and energy shortages have also been reported.

Therefore, it is so important that we work with the Pakistani government to ensure security, stability, and development in their country, and I look forward to our panel's views and suggestions on we how should do this.

The good news is that Pakistan's new Prime Minister, Yousaf Raza Gillani, has identified terrorism and extremism as Pakistan's most urgent problems.

So my questions for our panel are what aspects of our policy have been the most successful in serving the national interests of both the United States and Pakistan and what should we change as we move forward?

Anti-American sentiment persists across Pakistani society, and yet roughly three-quarters of the supplies for U.S. troops in Afghanistan pass either through or over Pakistan.

How can the United States fix its image amongst the Pakistani people and work towards greater cooperation with their new leadership?

I look forward to the testimony of our witnesses, and again, thank you, Mr. Chairman, for holding this important hearing.

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